



“The rural economy is also looking at a changing paradigm in agriculture... farmers are seeing potential to move to different crops”

said. How would you respond to him?

A: Should I respond to him as Raghuram Rajan the economist, or Raghuram Rajan the politician? The answer will depend on it... Because Raghuram Rajan had told us that we shouldn't invest any more in manufacturing... But when he wants to talk on China, he would compare. China has always invested hugely in manufacturing. I'm not imitating China, [but] we'll have to find ways in which our own strengths can be further leveraged. So that is one advice [from him] earlier. I find it difficult to take Rajan's advice, also because he was here holding a very responsible position as Governor of the Reserve Bank of India. The banks went through torment. The regulator looked away... then phone calls were going to banks and banks were yielding to phone calls. The regulator didn't tell them 'you will yield only to the banking norms and not to phone calls.' So Rajan, make up your mind when you speak to the government and nudge the media to ask them questions. Say, 'Look, I'm now wearing my economist hat. And sometimes I'm wearing my political hat.' That might be easy for us to address.

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SZ: Decades ago, Indians grew up with the slogan of *roti, kapda, makaan* (food, clothing, and housing). And in the last 10 years of Modinomics, *roti* and *makaan* seem to be taken care of, but *kapda* is missing...

A: *Kapda* is not missing, it is something that the family can choose to do if they are otherwise benefitted, in terms of the basic necessities... If an individual and his family is empowered enough, they will take a call on how they want to spend their money... I wouldn't want to quote Mao, but wasn't it he who said, 'Look, no good helping him to fish today [by] giving a fish in his hand. Give him

the skills to fish.' We are aiming to provide the basic facility and then give him access to different opportunities. He wants to do his own business, don't stifle him... Similarly, if those in villages want more technology in the fields, we are giving the drones, we are training them... simultaneously looking at the gender parity, and so on. So, the aim of this government is to empower the person to make his own decision. **BT**

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